

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 201

By Farmer

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate Dustin Helton on his selection as the 2024-2025 Sevier County School System Grades 9-12 Teacher of the Year.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to specially recognize those outstanding teachers who have devoted their careers to providing the highest quality education for Tennessee's students; and

WHEREAS, Dustin Helton is one such estimable educator, who has distinguished himself as a professional of the greatest dedication, ability, and integrity; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Helton has been selected as the 2024-2025 Sevier County School System Grades 9-12 Teacher of the Year, a most befitting honor that recognizes the positive influence he has on so many young lives; and

WHEREAS, in his ninth year as a social studies teacher at Pigeon Forge High School, Dustin Helton has served with acumen and alacrity as a teacher for ten years; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Helton is an extremely talented and compassionate educator who works assiduously to motivate his students to reach their full potential, both as scholars and as citizens; and

WHEREAS, one of Dustin Helton's most impactful initiatives as a teacher is his challenge to each semester's U.S. Government and Civics students to create impactful and sustainable school improvement projects; and

WHEREAS, another way in which he brings learning to life is by connecting students with prominent community individuals at the local, state, and national levels; over the years, he has invited local political party leaders to come and discuss their role within the larger party agenda, including former Governor Don Sundquist, Secretary of State Tre Hargett, former State Representative Dale Carr, and former State Senator Doug Overbey, to speak about their public service experience; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Helton serves as an inspiration to his colleagues and students alike, and his friendship and counsel are highly valued by those who are fortunate to know him; and

WHEREAS, Dustin Helton truly epitomizes the dedicated teacher who is wholly committed to the highest ideals of public service and quality education for all, and he should be specially recognized; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we hereby honor and congratulate Dustin Helton on being chosen as the 2024-2025 Sevier County School System Grades 9-12 Teacher of the Year, commend his exceptional service to the children of Tennessee, salute his professional expertise and personal excellence, and wish him all the best in his future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.